

BREADS & BAKES · 64% HYDRATION

Everyday *Loaf*

***The dough that does everything.** Built on a baker's formula at 64% hydration — soft enough for sandwiches, sturdy enough to shape free-form. The percentages are by weight of flour, so scale it up or down and it stays true.*

from the kitchen of Yahya

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1 LOAF • RISE 2 HRS • BAKE 30–35 MIN • 375°F (190°C)

FORMULA • 1 LOAF

Flour (AP or bread)	375 g • 100%	Sugar (or Honey)	12 g • 3.2%
Water (warm)	240 g • 64%	Salt	9 g • 2.4%
Butter or Oil	14 g • 3.7%	Active Dry Yeast	7 g • 1.9%
Total Dough		657 g • 175.2%	

Hydration = water ÷ flour × 100 = 64%. Aim for a final dough temp of 76–78°F (24–26°C).

METHOD

- 1 Bloom the yeast.** Stir yeast (7 g) and sugar (12 g) into warm water (240 g). Rest 5–10 min until foamy.
- 2 Mix.** Combine flour (375 g) and salt (9 g). Add the yeast water and butter or oil (14 g). Mix to a rough dough.
- 3 Knead.** 10 min by hand until smooth and elastic — it should pass a windowpane test.
- 4 Bulk rise.** Cover and ferment ~1 hr at warm room temperature, until doubled.
- 5 Shape.** Degas, shape into a tight loaf, seam-side down in a greased 9×5 in pan.
- 6 Proof.** Cover and proof 45–60 min, until it crowns ~1 in above the rim.
- 7 Bake.** 375°F (190°C) for 30–35 min, until deep golden and 200–205°F (93–96°C) inside.
- 8 Cool.** Turn out and cool on a rack at least 1 hr before slicing.

Yahya's note: the loaf is done when the thermometer says so, not when the timer rings. 64% hydration is forgiving — but weigh it either way.